



United States Department of the
Interior



FISH AND WILDLIFE SERVICE

Ohio River Islands National Wildlife Refuge

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Williamstown, WV 26187
304-375-2923 (Phone)
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December 10, 2012

Dear Partners and Interested Parties:

As part of our continuing effort to protect and restore riverine and riparian habitat in the Ohio River, we are partnering with the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, Pittsburgh District, to implement a comprehensive bank protection project on two of our Pennsylvania islands. Phillis and Georgetown Islands are located along the Ohio River at mile points 35 and 38 in Beaver County, PA. Both islands have experienced severe losses of land base due to inundation and erosion since the advent of modern navigation. The project would involve constructing low profile rock dikes, parallel to shore, and utilizing clean river-based material to fill behind the dikes. This material will become a new shoreline, with permanent riparian vegetation, and the rock dikes will arrest any future erosion of the islands. There will be gaps in the dikes to allow movement to and from the islands by people, boats, fish and wildlife. We have had great success building similar bank protection and shoreline stabilization projects on our other refuge properties. The attached sheet contains a location map, progression of island loss, and an illustration of the proposed bank treatment.

We will be developing detailed plans and an Environmental Assessment (EA) in the near future, and we would like to consider your comments and concerns early in our planning process. After the scoping process is completed and the draft EA is prepared, you will have an opportunity to comment on it before the Fish and Wildlife Service makes its decision.

Please submit your comments and concerns to us at the address below **by January 14, 2013**, and thank you for your time and interest in this project.

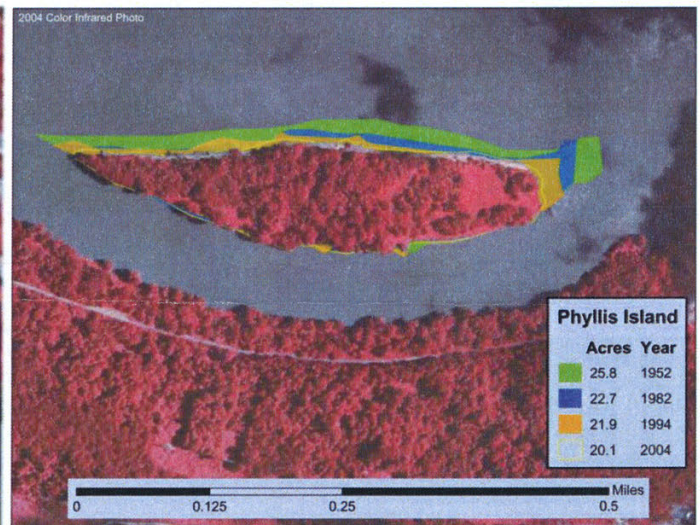
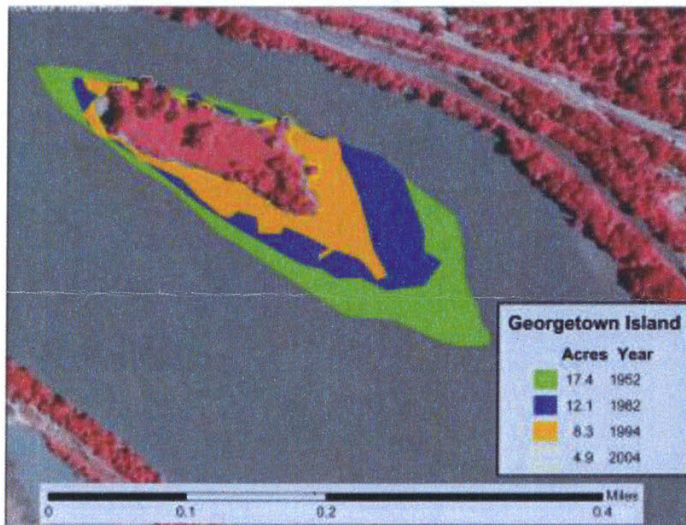
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Ohio River Islands NWR Bank Protection Project 2012-2017



Georgetown Island - <5 acres

Phillis Island - 20 acres



Shading depicts areas of acreage lost from 1952-2004
 Maps provided by US Fish & Wildlife Services, State College Field Office, 2004

Examples of similar erosion protection projects

